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The Role of the RBI

The central bank figures only after the army in terms of perception as a custodian of society's trust.

– Y.V. Reddy, Governor of the Reserve Bank of India 2003–2008

In my role as CEO and Chairperson of ABN AMRO and RBS in India, I had frequent interactions with the RBI at many levels, and had the opportunity to work with three RBI Governors – Y.V. Reddy, Duvvuri Subbarao and Raghuram G. Rajan.

With a significant treasury, consumer, corporate banking, diamond financing, and microfinance franchise, ABN AMRO, and later RBS Bank, in India was a systemically important foreign bank. We also ran the global back office, processing transactions for both RBS and ABN